

THE PROCESS OF AFFINITIZATION AND AFFINITY DIAGRAMS

SWE 4834: UI/UX Design Lab

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06 August 2025

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INTRODUCTION

WHAT IS AFFINITIZATION?

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Any task that requires processing of **huge bulk of unstructured data**, e.g., brainstorming, generation of new idea, or clarification of confusion or confounding factors can be benefited by the affinitization process.

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- Generate, sanitize, and group new ideas and concepts
- Identify problems and group them against specific targets
- And many more ...

WHEN TO USE AFFINITIZATION?

- There is **large volume** of data to filter
- Data is too complex to interpret directly
- Works best when participant count is around 5–6

Affinity Diagram – A diagram showing groups and hierarchy of data

Affinitization – The process that produces and affinity diagram

THE PROCESS OF AFFINITIZATION

Current section is based on:

- The Memory Jogger Plus+: Featuring the Seven Management and Planning Tools by Michael Brassard
- Contextual Design by Karen Holtzblatt and Hugh R. Beyer

SOME UNIQUE PROPERTIES OF THE AFFINITIZATION PROCESS



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SOME UNIQUE PROPERTIES OF THE AFFINITIZATION PROCESS

- Affinitize **SILENTLY!**
- Go for gut reaction, speed over deliberation
- Handle **disagreement** simply
- Build in one or two sessions over multiple smaller sessions

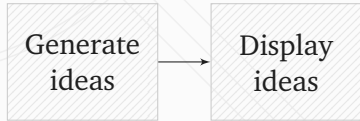
STEPS INVOLVED IN THE AFFINITIZATION PROCESS

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Generate
ideas

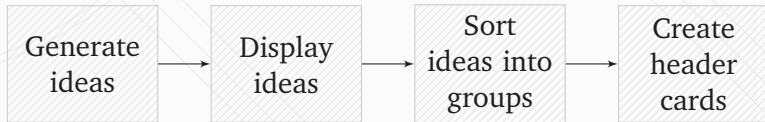
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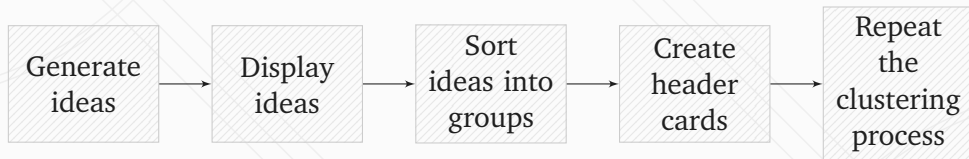
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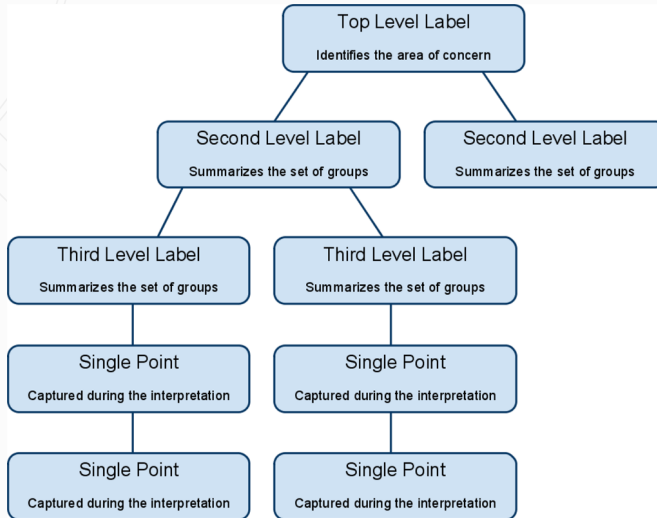
STEPS INVOLVED IN THE AFFINITIZATION PROCESS



WHAT DOES IT LOOK LIKE?

The affinity diagram consists of small sticky notes. Then different notes are grouped together under a header. Then they might be grouped again and so on. Generally different colors are used for different levels.

SKELETON OF AN AFFINITY DIAGRAM



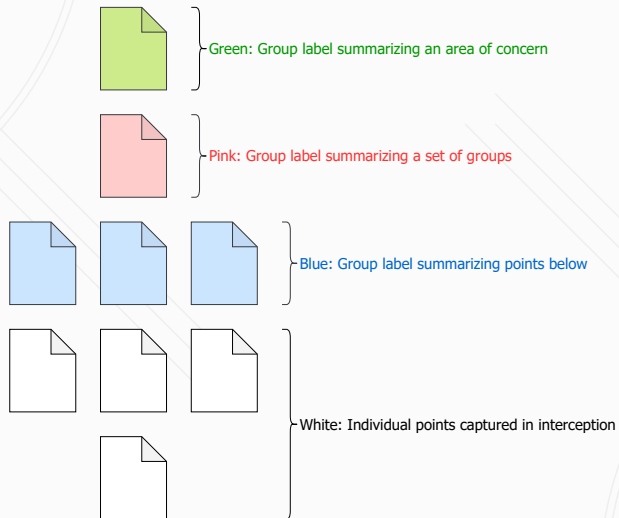
COLORS IN THE DIAGRAM

- The colors of the notes and how they correspond to grouping or other factors are not fixed.

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- The colors of the notes and how they correspond to grouping or other factors are not fixed.
- Rather they are task and goal dependent.

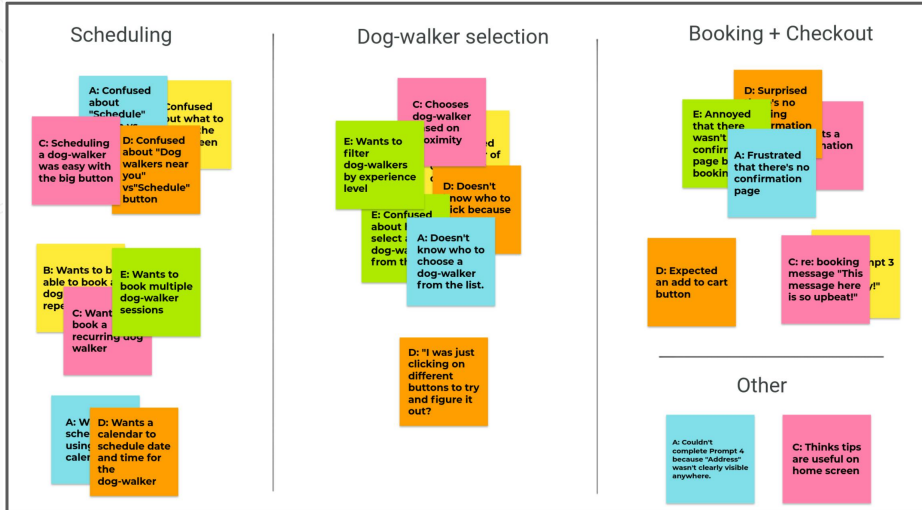
FOR CONTEXTUAL DESIGN (BEYER AND HOLTZBLATT)



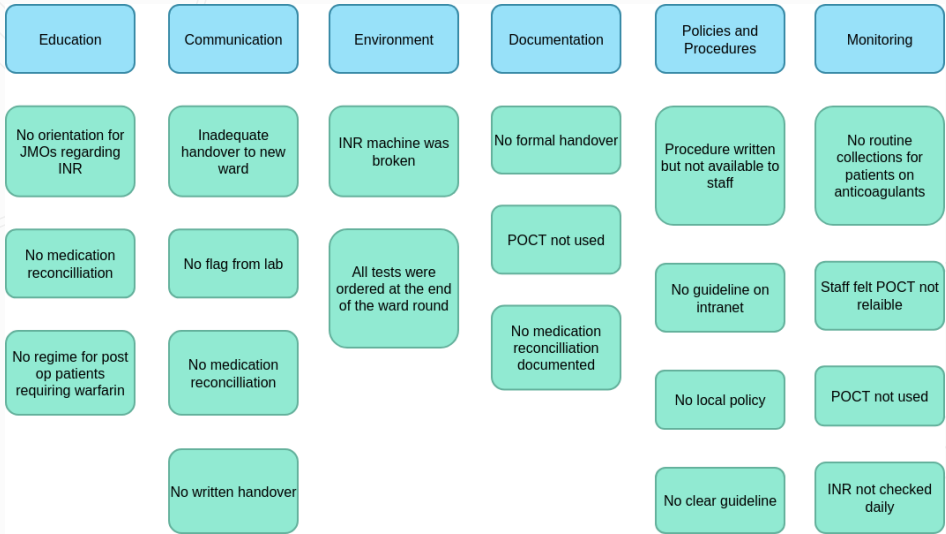
IN USABILITY STUDY

A: Confused about "Schedule" button vs "Dog walkers near you"	A: Wants to schedule using a calendar	A: Doesn't know who to choose or how to choose the best dog-walker from the list.	A: Frustrated that there's no confirmation page	A: Couldn't complete Prompt 4 because "Address" wasn't visible anywhere.	A: Wants a way to book a dog-walker every Saturday
B: Confused about what to press on the home screen	B: Commented on number of options for dog walkers	B: Wants to be able to book a dog-walker repeatedly.	B: re: Prompt 3 "That was super easy!"		
C: Thinks tips are useful on home screen	C: Scheduling a dog-walker was easy with the big button	C: Chooses dog-walker based on proximity	C: re: booking message "This message here is so upbeat!"	C: Wants a confirmation page	C: Wants to book a recurring dog walker
D: Confused about "Dog walkers near you" button and "Schedule" button	D: Wants a calendar to schedule date and time for the dog-walker	D: Doesn't know who to pick because of lacking details	D: Expected an add to cart button	D: Surprised there's no booking confirmation page	D: "I was just clicking on different buttons to try and figure it out?"
E: Wants to book multiple dog-walker sessions	E: Confused about how to select a dog-walker from the list	E: Annoyed that there wasn't a confirmation page before booking.	E: Wants to filter dog-walkers by experience level		

IN USABILITY STUDY



AN EXAMPLE AFFINITY DIAGRAM: HEALTH (FROM VISUAL PARADIGM)



EXAMPLE USE CASES

EXAMPLE: BRAINSTORMING SESSIONS

Tech Innovations Inc.

Tech Innovations Inc. is brainstorming ideas for a new smartphone app. After a creative session, they use an affinity diagram to categorize ideas into groups such as “User Interface Features”, “Functionality Enhancements”, and “Monetization Strategies”.

EXAMPLE: PRODUCT DEVELOPMENT

FreshFit Foods

FreshFit Foods is gathering feedback from customers about their meal plans. They use an affinity diagram to organize customer suggestions into categories like “Menu Variety”, “Portion Sizes”, “Special Menus”, and “Delivery Experience”.

EXAMPLE: PROCESS IMPROVEMENT

Global Logistics Solutions

Global Logistics Solutions wants to streamline their shipping process. They gather input from warehouse staff, drivers, and administrative personnel. Using an affinity diagram, they categorize suggestions into groups such as “Inventory Management”, “Route Optimization”, “Shipment Tracking”, “Customer Contact”, and “Documentation Procedures”.

EXAMPLE: ROOT CAUSE ANALYSIS

Quality Auto Parts Manufacturer

Quality Auto Parts Manufacturer is experiencing an increase in defective products. They conduct a root cause analysis and use an affinity diagram to categorize potential causes into groups such as “Supplier Issues”, “Production Equipment Malfunctions”, and “Employee Training”.

EXAMPLE: PROJECT PLANNING

GreenTech Solutions

GreenTech Solutions is planning a large-scale wind farm project. They use an affinity diagram to organize project tasks into categories like “Permitting and Regulations”, “Site Assessment and Preparation”, and “Turbine Installation and Testing”.

Thank You!

Any Question?